

suppress the normal cycle, followed by injections of a follicle-stimulating (and sometimes lutenizing) hormone. Egg retrieval will then take place (see [From eggs to embryos](#)).

ASK A DOCTOR

Should I monitor my menstrual cycle? Yes, this is an important part of planning for pregnancy because it can help you to roughly figure out which day you're ovulating (see [Pressure to conceive](#)). You can then ensure that you have sexual intercourse around the right time to improve your chances of conceiving.

If you have regular monthly periods, it is likely you are ovulating. It's helpful to note the length of your cycle, which may vary. Note that from ovulation to the start of your next period is around 14 days, so when you get your next period you can figure out roughly when you ovulated.